

Preparing OrchidApp for first use

First-run setup checklist for Windows

Use this guide after OrchidApp has been installed and a desktop or Start menu shortcut has been created. It shows the minimum setup needed before adding plants to the collection.

Before you start

You only need to do this setup once. You can add more plant groups, species / hybrids, growing locations and growth media later from Setup.

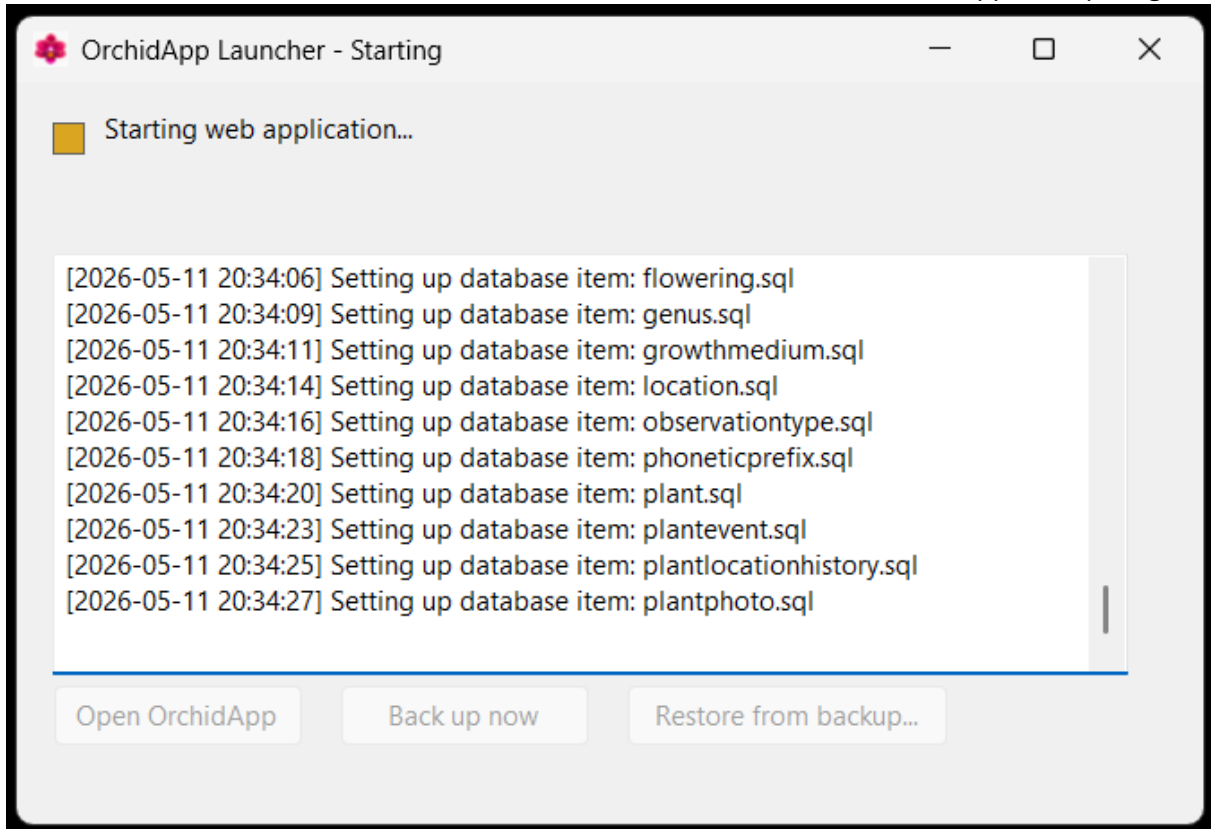
Quick checklist

- Start OrchidApp for the first time and wait for setup to complete.
- Open Setup from the Home page.
- Add at least one plant group, also called a genus.
- Add at least one species / hybrid under that genus.
- Add the growing locations and growth media you use. Screenshots for these can be added to this guide when available.
- Return to Home. OrchidApp is then ready for adding plants.

Step-by-step setup

1. Start OrchidApp

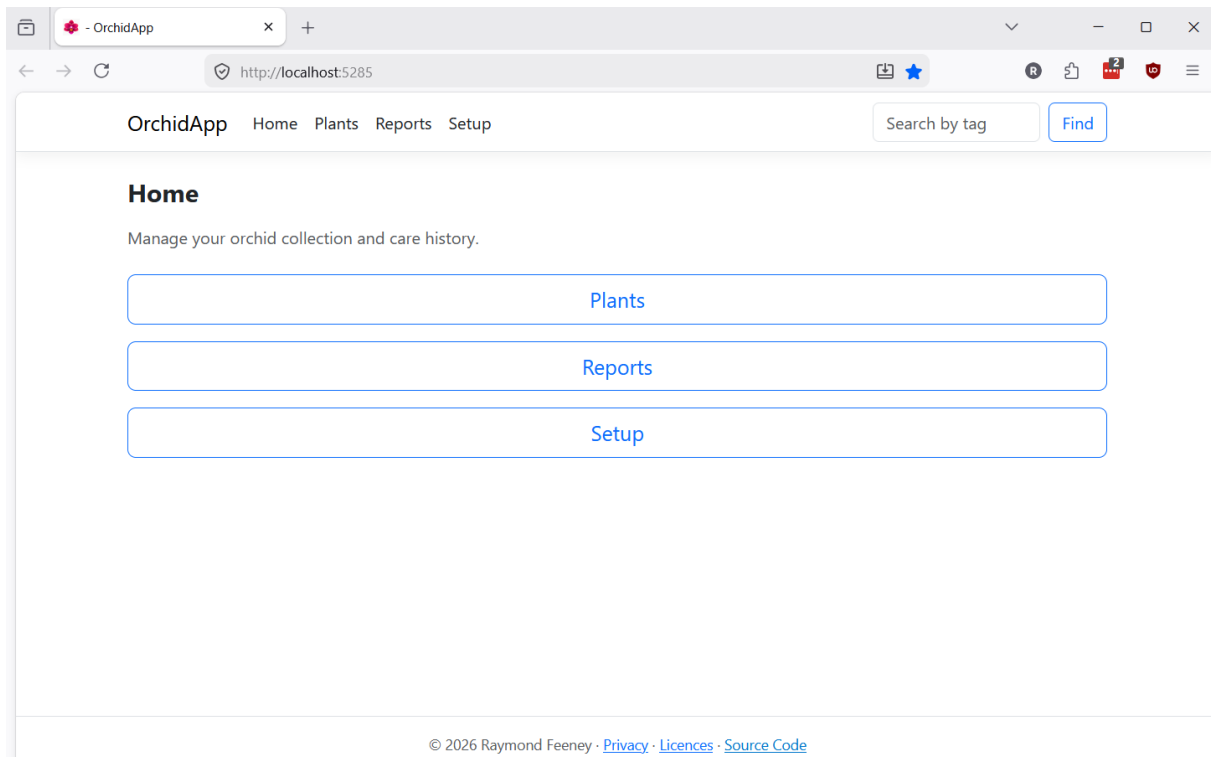
Launch OrchidApp from the desktop shortcut or the Start menu. On the first run, OrchidApp may need to create its database and supporting tables, this may take a few minutes. Wait until the setup window finishes and the app opens in your browser.



First launch: OrchidApp prepares the database automatically.

2. Open Setup

On the Home page, select Setup. This is where the basic lists are prepared before plants are added.

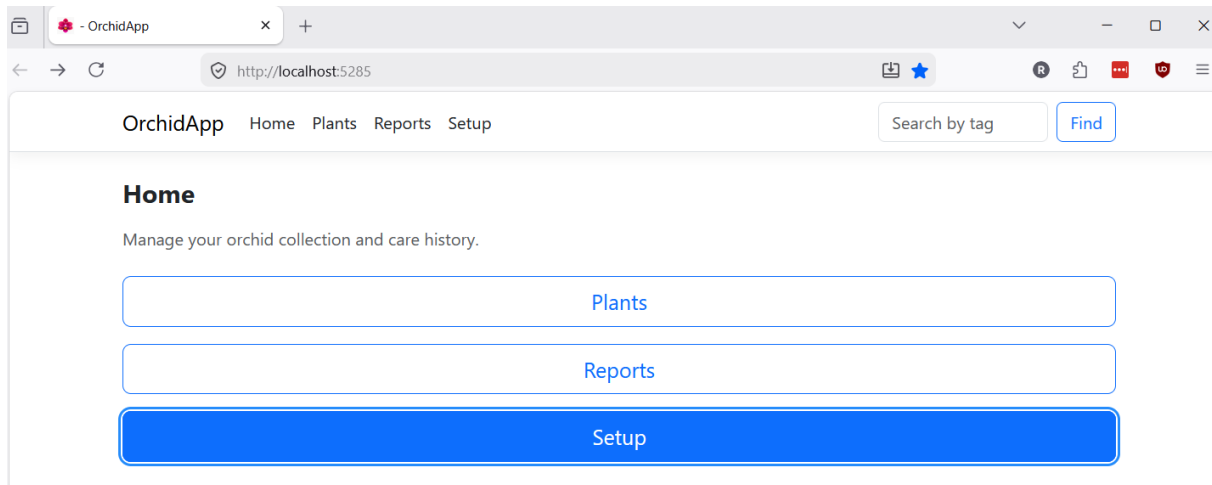


Home page with the Setup button.

Draft user guide

3. Choose what to set up first

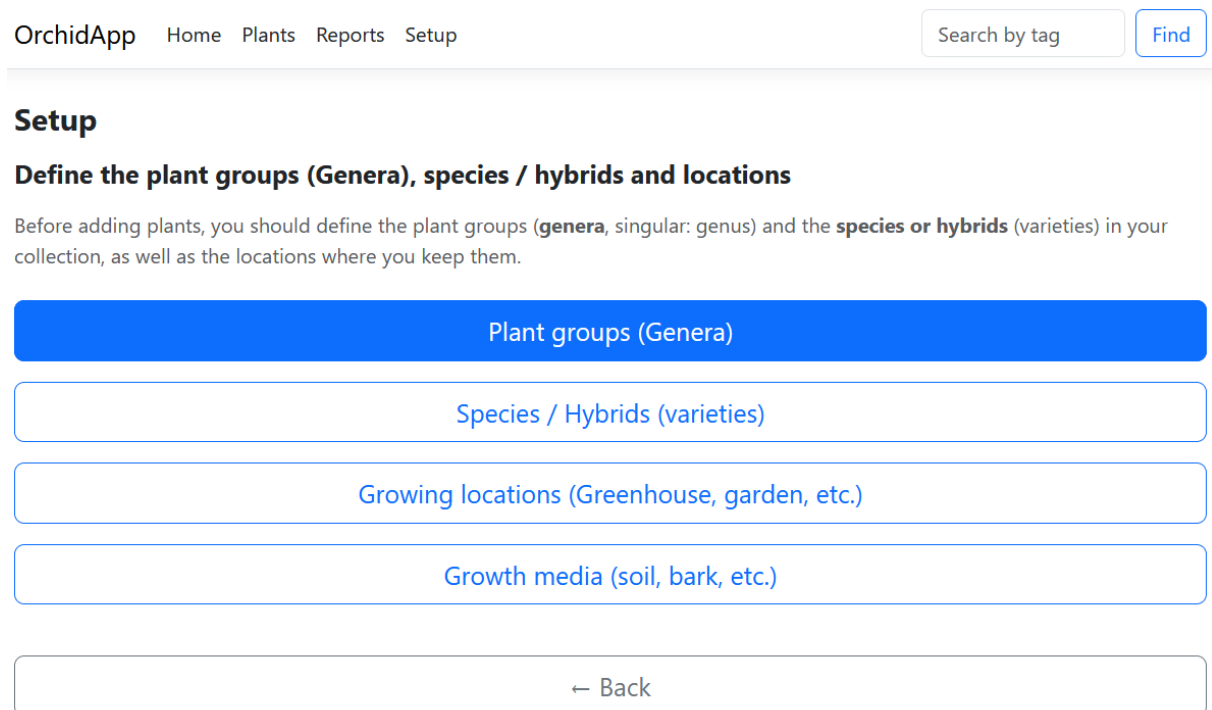
The Setup page groups the main things OrchidApp needs: plant groups (genera), species / hybrids, growing locations and growth media. Start with Plant groups because species / hybrids belong inside a plant group.



Setup page: choose Plant groups (Genera) first.

4. Add a plant group

A plant group is formally called a genus. Examples include Cattleya, Phalaenopsis and Dendrobium. Select Plant groups (Genera), then select Add genus.



Plant groups page with Add genus.

5. Enter the genus details

Enter the genus name. Notes are optional but useful for general care reminders that apply to the group. Select Add genus when finished.

Plant groups (Genera)

The main botanical groups your plants belong to

A plant group is formally called a **genus**. Examples include Phalaenopsis and Cattleya. Each genus only needs to be added once.

Add genus

Select a genus to view or edit its details.

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Genera page.

Complete the details you require and save (Add

Add genus

Create a new botanical group for your plants

A plant group is formally called a **genus**. For example: Phalaenopsis, Cattleya or Dendrobium. Each genus only needs to be added once.

Genus name

Enter the botanical genus name.

Cattleya

Notes

Optional notes about this plant group.

Warm-growing epiphyte. Likes bright filtered light, good air movement and a clear wet/dry cycle. Reduce watering slightly after growth matures. Check hybrid parentage as care can vary.

Add genus

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Add genus page.

6. Check the genus has been added

After saving, the genus appears in the Plant groups list. Select it later if you need to view or edit its details.

Plant groups (Genera)

The main botanical groups your plants belong to

A plant group is formally called a **genus**. Examples include Phalaenopsis and Cattleya. Each genus only needs to be added once.

Add genus

Select a genus to view or edit its details.

Cattleya

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Plant groups list showing the new genus.

7. Open Species / Hybrids

Return to Setup and select Species / Hybrids. Species and registered hybrids define the full botanical names used for plants.

Setup

Define the plant groups (Genera), species / hybrids and locations

Before adding plants, you should define the plant groups (**genera**, singular: genus) and the **species or hybrids** (varieties) in your collection, as well as the locations where you keep them.

Plant groups (Genera)

Species / Hybrids (varieties)

Growing locations (Greenhouse, garden, etc.)

Growth media (soil, bark, etc.)

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Species / Hybrids page.

8. Add a species or hybrid

Select Add species / hybrid. Choose the genus first, then enter either a species name or a hybrid name. Enter one name only. You may also add a representative image and notes.

Add species / hybrid

Create a botanical name within a genus

A plant belongs to one genus and is identified by either a species or a registered hybrid. Enter one name only.

Genus

Select the genus this species or hybrid belongs to.

Select a genus



Species name

Leave blank if adding a hybrid.

Hybrid name

Leave blank if adding a species.

Representative image

Optional. Helps with visual identification.

Browse...

No file selected.

Growth notes

Optional notes about growth characteristics.

Choose the genus before entering the species or hybrid name.

9. Save the species / hybrid

Complete the form and select Add species / hybrid. Representative images and notes are optional, but they make the list easier to recognise later.

Add species / hybrid

Create a botanical name within a genus

A plant belongs to one genus and is identified by either a species or a registered hybrid. Enter one name only.

Genus

Select the genus this species or hybrid belongs to.

Cattleya

Species name

Leave blank if adding a hybrid.

rex

Hybrid name

Leave blank if adding a species.

Representative image

Optional. Helps with visual identification.

Browse...

Rex.png

Growth notes

Optional notes about growth characteristics.

Large-growing Cattleya species. Best grown bright and warm with good air movement. Allow roots to dry between waterings but avoid keeping it dry for long periods while in active growth.

Notes

Optional notes about this species or hybrid.

Species from Peru and Bolivia, valued for large, fragrant flowers with a striking white to pale lavender form and a richly coloured lip. Worth tracking flowering behaviour and seasonal growth pattern carefully.

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Add species / hybrid

Example species / hybrid form ready to save.

10. Confirm the species / hybrid

After saving, the details page shows the genus, name, notes and image. From here you can edit the record or go back to the list.

Cattleya rex

Species / hybrid details

Genus	Cattleya
Species name	rex
Growth notes	Large-growing Cattleya species. Best grown bright and warm with good air movement. Allow roots to dry between waterings but avoid keeping it dry for long periods while in active growth.
Notes	Species from Peru and Bolivia, valued for large, fragrant flowers with a striking white to pale lavender form and a richly coloured lip. Worth tracking flowering behaviour and seasonal growth pattern carefully.


[Edit species / hybrid](#)
[Deactivate species / hybrid](#)
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Species / hybrid details after setup.

What to do next

Repeat the same basic process from Setup for:

- Growing locations, such as greenhouse, windowsill, garden or grow tent.
- Growth media, such as bark, moss, leca or mixed media.

Once those are set up, return to Home and start adding plants from the Plants section.

Keep the setup simple

You do not need to add everything on day one. Add enough information to start using OrchidApp, then improve the setup as your collection grows.

Optional reference: editing later

The first-run checklist deliberately avoids every edit screen. Use the edit pages later if you need to correct notes, replace an image or deactivate an item that should no longer be used for new plants.

Cattleya sp.

Species / hybrid details

Genus	Cattleya
Growth notes	—
Notes	—

Edit species / hybrid

Genus placeholder — managed automatically

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Example: species / hybrid details include an Edit species / hybrid button.